

CASE STUDY

COACHING FOR STRENGTHENING EMPLOYEE ENGAGEMENT

→ ABOUT:

Our client is an Indian multinational steel-making company, based in Jamshedpur, Jharkhand and headquartered in Mumbai, Maharashtra. An industry giant, it is among the largest steel producing companies in the world, with an annual crude steel capacity of 35 million tonnes. It is one of the world's most geographically diversified steel producers, with operations and commercial presence across the world.

→ CHALLENGE:

In the contemporary business landscape, employee engagement is a pressing concern, with the manager-direct report relationship at its core. Low engagement levels can severely impact productivity, customer satisfaction, and overall profitability. Moreover, the need for rapid innovation to stay competitive requires a highly engaged workforce. Workplace coaching has emerged as a key strategy to bolster manager-employee relationships and, consequently, enhance engagement. Two prominent coaching strategies are executive coaching, which aids senior leaders in specific areas, and performance coaching, which addresses performance issues.

Recognizing the paramount importance of nurturing a culture steeped in collaboration, empowerment, accountability, innovation, and high performance to fortify employee engagement, our client took a proactive step. They entrusted us with the task of equipping their top and middle-level leadership with coaching skills, with the ultimate goal of cultivating a high-performance coaching culture. This strategic move directly tackled the challenge of enhancing employee engagement by tailoring coaching to address the distinct challenges at each organisational level, thereby fostering collaboration and engagement organically within the organisation. This approach underscores the pivotal role of a coaching culture in driving organisational excellence and employee satisfaction.

→ OUR APPROACH:

Our streamlined program, designed for a broad audience of senior, mid-level, and frontline managers, equipped leaders with powerful, yet easy-to-use coaching tools. The objective was to develop senior leaders who are able to think and act strategically; thrive in the context of change enabling agility, creativity, collaboration, and innovation to flourish; and who create, find, and provide meaning and purpose at work. Collaborating with our client to meet the diverse coaching needs within the organisation, we delivered "The Art & Science of Coaching" program to 51 top leaders, who became certified coaches within the organisation. Subsequently, the "Leader as Coach Program" was rolled out to over 600+ AGM/GM/DGM level leaders, providing a condensed yet impactful coaching program. To prepare employees for coaching, we conducted a "Coaching Clinic" for over 400+ individuals who would receive coaching, fostering a conducive environment for coaching conversations.

In furtherance of our efforts to promote people orientation and team engagement, we identified and enrolled a specific group of middle-level managers in an intensive executive coaching program. This initiative not only honed their skills but also contributed to the establishment of an internal pool of certified coaches. These certified coaches are now positioned to provide coaching services to employees throughout the organisation, reinforcing our commitment to fostering a people-centric culture and driving team engagement.

→ CONTRIBUTION:

Through our holistic coaching approach, we initiated a subtle yet powerful transformation across the organisation. Leaders, equipped with coaching tools, evolved into strategic thinkers, adept at navigating change and fostering innovation. This shift infused work with deeper meaning and purpose, fostering a sense of engagement among employees. A gradual shift towards a coaching culture began to emerge, promoting collaboration and empowerment. As a result, a notable elevation in employee engagement was reflected in improved morale, heightened productivity, and a more positive work atmosphere.

